BEATING THE SUMMER BLUES

AS THE MERCURY RISES, FOLLOW THESE TIPS TO KEEP YOUR CAR IN GREAT SHAPE

When it comes to climate, we get the most varied kinds in our country. The smouldering summer is now on its way, with the pouring monsoons thrown into the mix later on. Such immense changes in temperature and weather conditions every few months have an adverse effect on everything that is exposed to the elements. Naturally, cars too are extremely vulnerable to the ravages of climatic variations, since they are often parked in the open.

To minimise the effects of weather on your car, we have a few pointers that will not only keep your vehicle in good health this summer, but also save you some money that you might otherwise spend in order to keep it running.

COOLING SYSTEM

Cars these days are made to be virtually maintenance-free and the days of looking at the radiator and coolant levels are passe, but just like you need the air-conditioning to keep cool, your car needs to run at optimum temperatures to perform well. Running the car in high temperatures at high engine speeds can do damage to the powerplant if the cooling system is not in the pink of health.

Get the radiator flushed to rid it of any residue, rust and metal particles that might have built up. Checking coolant level is not too difficult either as the coolant reservoir is marked with max and min level indicators. The important thing to keep in mind is the viscosity of the fluid. If it's too thin, then the coolant needs to be topped up.

BATTERY

High ambient temperatures are one of the main causes of battery trouble. Since the air-conditioner is in constant use during the summers and the blower fan is working overtime, it takes a toll on the battery.

Get the terminals and cables inspected for corrosion and get them cleaned. Sulphuric acid, which usually builds up with use, corrodes the terminals and plays havoc with the connection. This can also lead to a dead battery. Batteries are also more prone to losing electrolyte as a result of evaporation during the summer.

ENGINE OIL

Oil keeps the engine lubricated and prevents wear and tear of moving parts like the piston and cylinder. If used over a prolonged period, the engine oil loses viscosity and fine metal particles build up as metal parts wear down. This prevents the





THE CHECKLIST
1: Keep the car's cooling system in top condition 2: pressure wash to kep grime, corrosion at bay 3: check tyre tread 4: ventilate car before getting in